COURSE SYLLABUS

Academic Year 2025 - 26, Semester – [Fall / Spring]

ENT 141 – Fundamentals of Innovation and Entrepreneurship 1

Suggested version · updated 1 November 2026 · for department review

1. COURSE INFORMATION

Course Title:	Fundamentals of Innovation and Entrepreneurship 1			
Course Code:	ENT 141			
Course Identity:	Discover & Design · Semester 1 of the ENT journey			
Course Credit:	1-2-2 (1-hour lecture, 2-hour lab, 2 credits)			
Contact Hours:	Lec [15 Hrs], Lab/Non-Lec [30 Hrs] Total: 45 Hrs (1-hour lecture + 2-hour lab weekly)			
Course Pre-requisite(s):	None			
Course Co-requisite(s):	None			
Course Category:	University Requirement (GE):	✓	Program Requirement:	
Course Type:	Compulsory:	✓	Elective:	

2. FACULTY INFORMATION

Instructor Name:	This section will be filled at the time of offering of course.
Lecture/Lab Timings:	
Office Location:	
Office Hours:	
E-mail:	
Office Telephone:	
Course Website:	Course Website on Moodle

3. COURSE DETAILS

3.1 Course Description

The course builds an entrepreneurial mindset and the skills to discover and design. Students find real problems on campus, in the UAE and through the CUD Incubator's challenge cards, research them through observation and interviews, and build evidence-based personas. They use design thinking, associating, biomimicry and open innovation to generate and select ideas, turn one concept into a paper prototype, and present it at the Innovation Challenge Final with a 90-day roadmap. Each week has a 1-hour lecture and a 2-hour lab. Business models and market analysis follow in ENT 241.

3.2 Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) and Alignment to GE Learning Outcomes (GELOs)

On successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)		PLOs
CLO 1	Explain the basic concepts of innovation, entrepreneurship, and sustainability, and their value to the society and economy.	6

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)		PLOs
CLO 2	Demonstrate skills of effective teamwork and presentation.	**2**
CLO 3	Evaluate ideas and viable opportunities using the design thinking process.	**1,6**
CLO 4	Identify key elements of the sustainability framework in the proposed innovative opportunities.	**6**

4. TEACHING SCHEDULE

4.1 Lecture and Lab Schedule

Week No.	Topic Covered in Class	Class Activities	CLOs	Reference/ Course Material	Course Assessment *(Please specify if the assessment is out-of-class)*	
					Assignment Type	Due Date*
1	**Entrepreneurship & Entrepreneurial Mindset**	• Entrepreneurial Mindset Challenge: founder stories	1	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 1		
2	**Innovation & Creativity**	• Innovation Discovery Skills Challenge · Alternative Uses warm-up	1	Laverty & Littel (2020) §4.2		
3	**Sustainability, Triple Bottom Line & SDGs**	• SDG Problem Hunt (incubator challenge cards)	1, 4	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 3; UN SDGs; Chabani et al. (2025)		
4	**Problem Identification & Interview Techniques**	• Good Interview / Bad Interview role play	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 6	**A1 Innovation & SDG Problem Card**	Week 4
5	**Primary Research**	• Get Out of the Classroom Challenge	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 6		
6	**Research Analysis**	• Evidence Wall: pains, behaviours, needs, insights	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 6		
7	**User Persona**	• Persona Evidence Challenge	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 5		
8	**Market Research & Persona**	• Evidence Check: every claim has evidence	2, 3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 5	**A2 Research Evidence Pack**	Week 8
9	**Design Thinking: Define & Ideate**	• Real Brainstorming Session: HMW → 20–30 ideas	3	Stanford d.school; Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 6		
10	**Associating, Biomimicry & Open Innovation**	• Innovation Inspiration Workshop · open-innovation mini-challenge	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 4; Sergio & Tariq (cases)		
11	**Idea Evaluation & Convergent Thinking**	• Idea Tournament: select and justify one concept	3, 4	Traifeh et al. (2021); Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 5		
12	**Paper Prototyping**	• Rapid Prototyping Workshop · Break My Prototype	3	Stanford d.school		
13	**Poster + Prototype**	• Innovation Gallery Walk	2, 3	Stanford d.school	**A3 Prototype Poster + Gallery**	Week 13

Week No.	Topic Covered in Class	Class Activities	CLOs	Reference/ Course Material	Course Assessment *(Please specify if the assessment is out-of-class)*	
					Assignment Type	Due Date*
					Walk	
14	**Idea Refinement**	• Pivot or Persevere Challenge	3	Laverty & Littel (2020) §10.1		
15	**Implementation Planning**	• 90-Day Venture Roadmap Workshop	2	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 2		
16	**Final Venture Presentation**	• Innovation Challenge Final	2	Laverty & Littel (2020) Ch. 7	**A4 Innovation Challenge Final**	Week 16

**Due date will be included at the time of the offering of the course.*

4.2 Lab/ Non-Lecture Schedule

The 2-hour weekly lab runs the in-class activity listed for each week in 4.1.

5. TEACHING PEDAGOGY

The course is taught as a weekly 1-hour lecture and a 2-hour lab (1-2-2). In the lecture, the instructor presents one concept from the textbook with real UAE examples and the framework applied step by step. In the lab, students apply it in one hands-on activity (Section 4.1), in teams with rotating roles (leader, timekeeper, recorder, speaker), and keep a teamwork log.

Some lectures or labs may include a short contribution from a practising entrepreneur or a CUD Incubator partner, within the scheduled class time; this does not add contact hours and does not replace the lecture or the lab.

Students are encouraged to take part in hackathons, innovation challenges and competitions at CUD and UAE level.

Inclusive learning: Materials follow Universal Design for Learning. An Easy version of every lecture, lab, worksheet and assignment gives short numbered steps, a sentence starter, read-aloud and one part at a time, and students may show their learning by drawing, speaking or writing. Individual adjustments follow CUD's student-support process.

6. TEXTBOOK/REFERENCE BOOK/COURSE MATERIAL

Textbooks (TB):

a. Laverty, M., & Littel, C. (2020). Entrepreneurship. OpenStax. (Free, open textbook.)

Reference Books (RB):

a. Neck, H. M., Neck, C. P., & Murray, E. L. Entrepreneurship: The Practice and Mindset (3rd ed.). SAGE.
b. Tidd, J., & Bessant, J. Managing Innovation. Wiley.
c. Chabani, Z., Askri, S., & Kweh, Q. L. (Eds.) (2025). Sustainable Innovation in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) Region. IGI Global.

Suggested Readings (SR):

a. Sergio, R. P., & Tariq, M. U. Emerging Innovation: Business Transformation in the New Normal, 111 Compact Case Studies.

b. Traifeh, H., Abou Refaei, R., von Thienen, J., von Schmieden, K., Mayer, L., Osman, S., & Meinel, C. (2021). Mapping Design Thinking in the Arab World. In Design Thinking Research. Springer, Cham. p. 41-60.

c. Stanford d.school design thinking resources.

7. LEARNING RESOURCES

Course website on Moodle contains class announcements, lecture notes, assignments and submission links. An interactive course website supports the classes with lecture scenes, lab guides and a course assistant; it does not replace classes, attendance or class activities. The CUD Incubator challenge board publishes partner challenges.

8. COURSE ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION

The information concerning the appropriate distribution of grade weight amongst various assessment items and their corresponding linkage with the stated CLOs is provided in the following table.

Assessment Items		Grade Weight (%)	Course Learning Outcomes			
			1	2	3	4
A1	Innovation & SDG problem card (Week 4)	25	✓			✓
A2	Research evidence pack (Week 8)	25			✓	
A3	Prototype poster + gallery walk (Week 13)	25			✓	
A4	Innovation Challenge Final (Week 16)	25		✓		

9. ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

All four assignments follow a block of study and are created in class, so every student practises with the instructor present.

A1 – Innovation & SDG problem card (Individual, Week 4, 25%): One innovation you admire (what changed, which of the 4Ps) and one real problem from the SDG Problem Hunt, mapped to the triple bottom line.

A2 – Research evidence pack (Team, Week 8, 25%): Interview notes, Evidence Wall insights and an evidence-based persona, completed in writing in class. No presentation.

A3 – Prototype poster + gallery walk (Team, Week 13, 25%): HMW question, idea tournament result and a paper prototype on a poster, shown at the Gallery Walk.

A4 – Innovation Challenge Final (Team, Week 16, 25%): Problem → evidence → user → ideas → prototype → feedback → 90-day roadmap, presented with the teamwork log.

10. COURSE REQUIREMENTS AND POLICIES

The students are required to fully understand and observe the following policies of the university.

10.1 Attendance Policy

Attending classes is compulsory in all courses. CUD Students will not be allowed to take the final examination if they are absent for 25% or more of the classes in a course. (Students should refer to their respective Department or School/Faculty for additional specific program-related information.)

a. When a student has been absent for 10% of the course an absence reminder would be sent by email.
b. When a student has been absent for 20% of the course a second absence reminder would be sent by e-mail
c. When a student has been absent for 25% of the course a notice of Failure for Non-Attendance will be sent by email and grade "FA" with Grade Point of 0.0 will be awarded.

A student with a verifiable and legitimate reason for missing a class (e.g., hospitalization) may request his instructor not to count such an absence towards the 25%. Such excusable absences must be noted in the Course File Attendance Report.

Should an acceptable explanation for a student's absenteeism be available, the Dean/Designated Representative of the Faculty concerned may consider the student's withdrawal without penalty from the particular course. A withdrawal without penalty or any other alpha grade under these circumstances may only be considered with the consent of the Registrar.

10.2 Incomplete Work Policy

Students whose course work is at a passing level but who for verifiable reasons beyond their control are unable to finish course work by the end of a term (or the specified end of a course) may be granted a grade of "Incomplete".

The "I" is not intended to be a permanent grade. It is only a temporary acknowledgment of a legitimate reason for granting a one-time, limited extension to the time normally allowed to complete all course requirements.

Students have up to 12 calendar months after the scheduled end of the course to complete required additional work as determined by the teacher who assigned the "I", and to thereby qualify for a passing grade.

After 12 calendar months, outstanding "I" grades are converted to "F".

Thereafter, the student must repeat the course in order to achieve a passing grade.

The number of "Incomplete" courses allowed per semester is established by the School. Please contact the School for further information.

NOTE: An Incomplete grade for a pre-requisite course must be completed before the student is allowed to proceed to the higher-level course unless otherwise approved by the appropriate Academic Administrator (Dean or Designate).

10.3 Academic Integrity

Cheating refers to attempting or using unauthorized materials or obtaining unauthorized assistance in an academic activity, including all types of examinations or evaluations. This may include impersonating another student; looking at another student's materials; using unauthorized notes/books/calculators; talking to other students; using communication devices such as mobile phones or any Bluetooth devices.

Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, representation of others' work, lending unauthorized assistance, and using strategies or processes with the aim of attaining dishonest grades on tests or examinations. Students may not submit any material created by or acquired from another person or business. Plagiarizing any type of course work will not be tolerated. All instances of plagiarizing shall be documented, presented to the Head/Dean of the program and to the Registrar, and recorded in the student's file. The maximum permissible similarity index limit is 20% for the assignments required to be submitted through Turnitin.

Any violation of the academic integrity policy is a serious offence which will be sanctioned as per the Academic Integrity Policy published in the Student Handbook. Please refer to the Catalogue for further information on student Academic Integrity.

11. GRADING SYSTEM

The University uses the relative grading system which is based on a four-point scale. An overall grade will be assigned on the following grading scale.

Percentage Score	Alpha Grade	GPA Points	Percentage Score	Alpha Grade	GPA Points
90-100	A+	4.0	60-64	C	2.0
80-89	A	3.8	55-59	D+	1.5
75-79	B+	3.5	50-54	D	1.0
70-74	B	3.0	0-49	F	0.0
65-69	C+	2.5			

The students must also read and comprehend the full version of the "Grading System" of the University which is published in the relevant Catalogue.

12. GRADING RUBRICS FOR ASSESSED ELEMENTS

Grading Rubric for A1: Innovation & SDG problem card (25 marks)

A1: Innovation & SDG problem card	Excellent (100–81%)	Good (80–61%)	Developing (60–41%)	Weak (40–0%)
Innovation and what changed (7 marks)	Names one clear change, precisely.	The change is named but vague.	Partly done; important gaps.	No clear change.
Innovation type (4Ps) (6 marks)	Correct type, justified against the other three.	Correct type, weak reason.	Partly done; important gaps.	Wrong type or no reason.
Real problem with evidence (6 marks)	Problem seen or heard in the Problem Hunt.	Problem stated, little evidence.	Partly done; important gaps.	No real problem.
Triple bottom line and SDG (6 marks)	People, planet, profit and a fitting SDG.	Partly mapped.	Partly done; important gaps.	Not mapped.

Grading Rubric for A2: Research evidence pack (25 marks)

A2: Research evidence pack	Excellent (100–81%)	Good (80–61%)	Developing (60–41%)	Weak (40–0%)
Evidence (8 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Insights (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.

A2: Research evidence pack	Excellent (100–81%)	Good (80–61%)	Developing (60–41%)	Weak (40–0%)
Persona (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Clarity (5 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.

Grading Rubric for A3: Prototype poster + gallery walk (25 marks)

A3: Prototype poster + gallery walk	Excellent (100–81%)	Good (80–61%)	Developing (60–41%)	Weak (40–0%)
Ideas (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Selection (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Prototype (7 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Feedback used (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.

Grading Rubric for A4: Innovation Challenge Final (25 marks)

A4: Innovation Challenge Final	Excellent (100–81%)	Good (80–61%)	Developing (60–41%)	Weak (40–0%)
Story (7 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Evidence (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Roadmap (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.
Teamwork (6 marks)	Fully meets the criterion, with clear evidence.	Mostly meets it; minor gaps.	Partly meets it; important gaps.	Little or no evidence.

13. VERIFICATION

(i) I verify that the contents of this document are up to date.

Instructor's Name and Signature Date

(ii) I have reviewed this course syllabus and state that it complies with CUD policies and guidelines.

_____ _____

Name and Signature of Department Chair/Program Coordinator Date

Note: *This page of the course syllabus is only for the purpose of documentation and therefore it should not be distributed to the students.*